Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
February 11, 2026

ATTENDEES
(V = voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal
Andi Gourlay - Vice-Principal
Cheraine Serrador - Chair
Carrie-Ann Delane - YMCA
Zac Jones (V)
Vina Danger (V)
Chantelle Tinnes (V)
Dipesh Patel (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V)
Shannon Wall (V)
Christine Dalsto (V)
Yvonne Branski (V)
Cindy Ma (V)
Stephanie MacLachlan (V)
Ashley Church (V)
Selena Mather (V)
Natalie Nowak

Regrets

Kim Fowler - community rep
Bibi Corbeil - teacher rep
Vasco Serrador (V)
Rene Corbeil (V)
Amy Ellison (V)
Rebecca Goodard

Meeting Minutes

1. **Welcome & Introductions**
   - Mr Wilson shared the territorial acknowledgment from the staff meeting, focusing on connections to water. Often thoughts on water are negative e.g. the snow and ice, the leak in the school roof
   - Mr Wilson touched on land vs territorial acknowledgment. A land acknowledgment thanks the natural world and all the things in it that help sustain life
   - Carrie-Ann Delane introduced herself as the supervisor of the YMCA daycare facility, which is an independent organisation but is connected to Clemens Mill PS

2. **Principals Update**
   - Positive update for the parking lot - lobbying has resulted in a large pile of snow being removed from the lot to free up parking spots/space
   - Report cards were sent home on 9th Feb
   - Ongoing communication between families and teachers are very important
   - Porta-Pack leak - WRDSB had restoration workers to the school within 1-2hrs to help make classrooms safe again. One class was able to return to their classroom by 11:15 on the day of the leak. Most of the restoration work is complete, with outstanding items (drywall) to be completed by end of the week
   - Scientist in School - A teacher stopped Mr Wilson in the hallway to express gratitude for the program. Every class in GRs1-6 have now had the opportunity to use the program and positive feedback is being heard from teachers. Thanks to the school council for allocating funds to this program
   - School Sign - have not heard back from other vendors. Original vendor has provided a quote for $7642 to replace panels and add lights. Mr Wilson is hoping to get a mockup
   - Students have had many opportunities this month:
     - GSA conference
     - Black Brillance conference
     - GR 3 “My Body Is Mine” workshops
     - GR 8 MADD presentation
     - GR 8 Skills Ontario presentation about skilled trades and technology
     - GR 8 celebration photos
   - Kindy registration is now open. If you have a child born in 2022 contact the school to find out how to get them registered
   - Dolphin Gotchas
     - New initiative to encourage community spirit
     - “I showed Dolphin Pride”
     - Teachers fill out the slip. One half will be displayed on a bulletin board and the other half will go home with the student
     - Suggestion that students photos could be taken and displayed within the school and also a monthly raffle for Gotcha slips
   - Bingo Fridays and Dolphin scavenger hunts were mentioned as previous school community initiatives. No current plans to bring back but they will be looked at for the future
   - Question about whether the land acknowledgement has seen any gains in the school? No significant outward gains. Are hoping that staff will start to present the acknowledgement and there will be more discussions with kids and teachers. Also hoping for more social justice initiatives and more visible learning within the school e.g Black History Month

3. **Budget Summary**
   - Ended at $57.4k
   - Cash of $49.5k and bingo $7.9k
   - Minimal changes this month with most of allocated funds yet to be spent

- Grade 7 & 8 end of year trip - deposits are already being received
- Scientist in Schools - invoices coming in and will be paid soon
- Music - $2.6k already spent and other items being ordered
- PRO Grant has been spent on the board games for family night
- K4 money has been spent
- Carnivale should come in under budget
- School sign should come in under budget

4. Bingo Update

- Only shift without volunteers this year is Sun Dec 27, 2026
- Looking for backups for all shifts. Natalie Nowak asked to have her name put down as backup for all shifts and confirmed she is already trained
- Suggestion for school to provide update to parents about how bingo funds are used in an effort to secure more volunteers

5. WRAPSC Update

- Parents urged to contact MPPs to support the WRDSB and show that education is important to tax payers. MPP contact details can be provided
- Proposal to stagger PRO Grant reporting deadline next year
- PIC is focusing on outdoor play and education. Parent info night in April called “Lets grow things”
- Logs can be used in the school grounds as long as they can be carried in by a person and would need to be done intentionally and without causing any restrictions for kids with mobility issues
- SCIS report uploaded on school website, go to “Quick Links” at the bottom of the school homepage. Each school must have a committee to respond to the survey results
- April WRAPSC meeting will focus on AI and highschool

6. Safe Caring and Inclusive School (SCIS) Report

- Survey is done every spring and asks students about things like safety, bullying, sleep and connections with family and friends
- Mr Wilson will prepare a report on the survey results and how to use the survey but is generally not content with the results of the survey
- The school is already working on a SCIS committee to respond to the survey. It is strongly felt that the student voice is important, and a meeting has already occurred with 18 students from GRs 7 and 8 to talk about their concerns
- The student voice can offer simple solutions that have real a impact
- Parent involvement is also being sought, please reach out to Mr Wilson if you would like to participate
- Question about how kids were chosen to participate in the feedback meeting? Volunteers were requested and they also talked to students who had already had discussions about these topics. All classes are represented by the students.

7. Upcoming Events

Family Games Night

- Only 5 families have signed up for the event, please sign up!
- 5 volunteers required
- Hoping this event is the start of an ongoing event for the school and possible expansion

Booster Juice

- Kids are already excited for the event
- Event already has sufficient volunteers

Family Movie Night

- Previously agreed date has a conflict so a new date will need to be agreed

End Of Year Celebration

- Currently 5 volunteers for the committee
- Need 8-10 volunteers for setup and teardown
- Another 3 volunteers put their hands up at the meeting
- Last years event was very well attended, but was also a great success and actually made money
- The Chair will put together a zoom for a first meeting for committee members. Hoping to start assigning tasks and ownership.
- Initial meeting will also draft a budget to be presented to council

8. Meeting close

- March meeting CANCELLED
- Next meeting APR 8th at 7pm (virtual)